06 | AT YOUR DESK

Six steps for a clear request

Use for a decision request, escalation, or follow-up on an unresolved item.

Step	Check before sending
1. Name the exact decision	Can the reader tell what answer, approval, or clarification I need?
2. Check authority and boundaries	What can I decide or continue? What needs another authorized person?
3. Gather facts and required input	What do I know? What remains unconfirmed? Whose input is required?
4. Offer options and a recommendation	What are the workable choices? What do I recommend, and why?
5. Use the correct route and verify timing	Who owns the decision? What deadline is real? What reply or next update is confirmed?
6. Track the reply and close the loop	Who will track the request, carry out the next action, and update others?

Verify three different times

Decision needed by: _____ **Expected reply by:** _____

Next update, if unresolved: _____ **Confirmed with:** _____

For a follow-up request

Use the original request and agreed update date. State what remains unanswered, any new facts, and the effect of waiting. Check for an existing reply before sending a duplicate.

> **Routine response and urgent needs**
> Escalated questions receive an answer or a named response owner within two working days. More time requires a next update. Immediate risks and required deadlines use the proper urgent route.

Training basis: Decision & Escalation, six-step request checklist; Communicating CLEAR, final series, slide 41. Follow-up prompts are an application of the sequence.